



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

EARLY FALL 2022

Rally Day

We start back with our fall programming year on Rally Day, which is September 11 this year.

- ★ One worship service at 10:00, outside
- ★ Name tags so we can learn/re-learn one another's names, plus the addition of pronouns
- ★ A Minnesota Grown potluck after the service (see details below)
- ★ Dunk tank!

We will be focusing on Creation Care and Environmental Justice this fall, so our potluck will have the theme of "Minnesota Grown," and you get to decide what that means. We'll have notecards for you to fill out for our potluck item so you can list its ingredients as well as why you consider this Minnesota Grown. If the corn came from your garden, write that down. If the cookies were purchased at Cub, a store in Minnesota, then write that down. If your entire dish is purple in honor of Prince . . . you get the idea. In addition, we'll have an informal vote on the dishes and their descriptions just to add to the fun.

Please bring some cash for tickets as well – tickets for the dunk tank as well as tickets for voting on the dishes. All money collected will go to our Climate Action Committee for work on reducing our carbon footprint at the church.



VBS Compassion Camp

Fall Worship

As we enter into fall, we also enter into our programming life of the church. We'll finish out the summer outside, and then move back to our regular schedule of 2 worship services in the sanctuary. The focus for September and October will be Robin Wall Kimmerer's book *Braiding Sweetgrass*, and there will also be a study group meeting to talk about the book on Tuesday mornings.

- ★ August 28 is our annual pet blessing; bring your pet, or a stuffed animal, or a picture of your pet to be blessed.
- ★ Sept. 4 is Labor Day weekend; we will be outside for worship at 10:00.
- ★ Rally Day is September 11, and it will be our last Sunday outside. One service at 10:00, with a potluck following (see separate article).
- ★ Sept. 18 is the beginning of our fall program year, with worship at 9:00, 11:00, and faith formation at 10:15.
- ★ Sept. 18 is also Confirmation Sunday when we recognize all the 10th graders who completed the confirmation program last program year.
- ★ Sept. 25 – Oct. 23 is the sermon series on *Braiding Sweetgrass*.

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United Women in Faith

Your Women United in Faith are gearing up for another busy fall. Minnehaha's chapter of Women United in Faith includes all the women of our church and all the men who want to come! Any anyone else left over! Our mission is to serve women and children locally, nationally and around the world. Please choose which activity from our fall list you'd like to attend, run, be a part of!!



United
Women
in Faith



Music and Drama Camp



*** Serving a dinner at Simpson Housing Shelter on 28th St. E. and 1st Ave. has been a continuing mission that we finance and enjoy. Serving meals, including prepping the food, this summer were Kevin Korell, Craig Johnson, Char Johnson, Kitty Campbell, Sarah Emrick, Margaret Rawson, Dave Noren, John Darlington, Paula Barton, Susan DeLaittre, Joe Schlosser, Kim Kanuit and Maureen Trepp. We welcome anyone new who would like to help: meet at church to carpool on the day of the meal at 5:30 or meet us at Simpson. The serving usually ends about 8:00. Our next meal is Wed., Sept. 28 followed by Wed., Oct. 26, Mon. Nov. 28 and Tuesday Dec. 27. Please let Maureen Trepp know that you are interested!

***All Church Rummage Sale! Coming Sept. 15-17, Thursday- Saturday with a bag sale until noon on Saturday. Sign up for a shift; set-up on Tuesday, Sept. 13 from 4-8, Wed. Sept. 9-noon, noon-3, 3-6 and 6-8 and working at the sale on Sept. 15 8:30-6, Sept. 16, 8:30-6 and Sept. 17 8:30-noon, with clean-up after noon. Please let Maureen or Kim Kanuit know when you'll be helping! **BRING RUMMAGE on Sun., Sept. 4 or Sept. 11 and leave in the Fellowship Hall- no furniture or clothing.**

*** We want to get back together again! Covid changes have occurred and we want to see you....and your face! Come to the WUF gathering at Casa Maria on 34th Ave. and 50th Street on Thursday, Oct. 6 for Happy Hour: 4-7:00. Come and drop in! Please let us know you're coming so we can get a big table!



***Congratulations to Chloe Kennedy-Abdella who will be attending college this fall with a scholarship from your WUF. Chloe will be going to Chippewa Valley Technical College and looking at majoring in nursing. Thank you for applying!

*** We've got Native American Wild Rice! The real thing! 1 lb. for \$15 and 2 lb. for \$30. For sale between services!

***Our Annual Holiday Bazaar, with all the rice pudding, sloppy joes, pies, fun things to buy, baked goods, egg bake, caramel rolls, chicken hot dish (YES! Everything you hope for in a Holiday Bazaar) will be Sat., Nov. 12 from 10:00-2:00. Please let Maureen know if you want to be a vendor, if you want to donate baked goods, if you want to help and come!!

How do you let Maureen know all these things? Email is best at maureentrepp@yahoo.com or tell her at church or message with your name at 612-387-2520.

Newsletter Schedule

Since early spring, we have been trying a different thing with our newsletter. Rather than a monthly newsletter, we are trying to provide newsletters that cover a programming period. For those of you submitting information to go out in the newsletter, here is our planned schedule for the remainder of this calendar year:

- Deadline Nov. 11, mailed Nov. 18
- Deadline Dec. 16, mailed Dec. 27

And, if you miss a deadline, don't forget that the vast majority of our folks get the weekly e-news, and you can always put information in that as well. We do try to make the e-news shorter by having events that are 1-3 weeks away, so you are welcome to have a quick "save the date" article further out, but then provide information closer to the event.

Covid-19 Guidelines

Now that vaccines are available for all ages of our community, we will be using this set of metrics (based on CDC guidelines) for our worship and activities this year.

Community level of **Green**:

- Masks are optional.
- All programming happens as scheduled.
- Communion is served with individual pieces of bread and individual cups.

Community level of **yellow**:

- Masks are required indoors.
- All programming happens as scheduled, but we hold events outside as much as we can.
- Communion is served with individual pieces of bread and individual cups.

Community level of **red**:

- Masks are required inside.
- Any programming involving food is cancelled or postponed.
- Communion is served pre-packaged.

In addition, we have 5 air filters that are portable and can be used in any of our classroom spaces. We anticipate having these in our Sunday School classrooms on Sunday mornings, but they can be used by other groups at other times during the week. If you want an air filter for your class or event, please contact Jean Elliott.







FALL SUNDAY SCHOOL

OPEN HOUSE - SEPT. 11TH:
TAKE OUTDOOR CLASS PHOTOS & VISIT CLASSROOMS

SEPT. 18TH:
CLASSES BEGIN & MEET FROM 10:15-11:00 AM



PRESCHOOL - ROOM 202
KINDERGARTEN & 1ST GRADE - ROOM 206
2ND & 3RD GRADE - ROOM 208
4TH & 5TH GRADE - ROOM 306
MIDDLE SCHOOL - ROOM 302/304
HIGH SCHOOL - ROOM 308



SEE YOU THERE!



MINNEHAHA

YOUTH GROUPS KICK-OFF NIGHT



SUNDAY SEPT. 11th 4:00-5:30 PM	1) COMBINED GROUP ACTIVITY 2) EACH YOUTH GROUP SHARES GOALS AND IDEAS FOR FUTURE EVENTS AND ACTIVITIES
	 MIDDLE SCHOOL  HIGH SCHOOL





KoWaKan Youth Trip

Christmas Gift Shopping

SUNDAY, NOV. 20

Both youth groups will travel to Target and shop for gifts for the Food Shelf Gift Collection.



Children's Council Invites You To:

Young Families Fall Dinner

Sunday, October 2nd
5:00 pm Room 210

Babies, toddlers, and their families are invited to come and play, connect, and be in community with other young families.

Dinner is provided, so come for a relaxing evening together.

Questions? Contact Jean Elliott at education@minnehaha.org

MINNEHAHA
CHILDREN, YOUTH & FAMILIES

Wednesday Night Programs

5:30-6:15 Dinner

6:15-7:00 Kindergarten & Younger:

Open Playtime in Rooms 202 & 204

6:15-7:00 Children's Choir in Room 310

6:15-7:00 Youth Gym Games & Homework Hangout in Room 302/304

6:15-7:15 Confirmation Class in Room 308



Youth Kick Ball

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us on Oct. 14 and Nov. 11 for a time of renewal. The service is also livestreamed, so you can worship through your screen, wherever you are, either in real time or anytime after.



Adult Faith Forum

This last Spring during the last Minnehaha Adult Faith Forum, our classes discussed controversial topics in Christianity, including abortion, teaching evolution in schools, euthanasia, prayer in public schools, and other equally controversial topics.

In those classes, we followed video comments by the Rev. Adam Hamilton, the nationally well-known senior pastor of the 25,000-member United Methodist Church of the Resurrection in Leawood, Kansas, the largest United Methodist congregation in the world.

During those classes, we noted that one way to consider what we should believe as Christians is to use the United Methodist quadrilateral view of faith.

The United Methodist quadrilateral is the view, originally proposed by John Wesley in the late 18th Century, that faith is best formulated using Tradition, Reason, Experience, and most importantly, Scripture, that is, the Bible.

September 18, we will again begin meeting between Church services, from about 10:10 to just before 11 am, as adults, and will be discussing the Bible, this most important segment of the United Methodist quadrilateral.

Marshall Cook will continue to lead these classes utilizing a series from the Great Courses, entitled, "The Story of the Bible." This lecture series is presented by Professor Luke Timothy Johnson, Ph.D., Professor of New Testament and Christian Origins at the Emory University's Candler School of Theology in Atlanta, GA.

Among the topics we will consider are the formulation of the Jewish Bible (The TaNaK), The Birth of the Christian Bible, The Writing and Copying of Manuscripts, Old Latin and Vulgate Copies of the Bible, The Printing of the Bible, Translating the Bible into English, The King James Bible, Searching for the Critical Bible Text, the Historical-Critical Approach to the Bible, the Bibles of Contemporary Christians, and perhaps extra discussion of the Bible and Mythology.

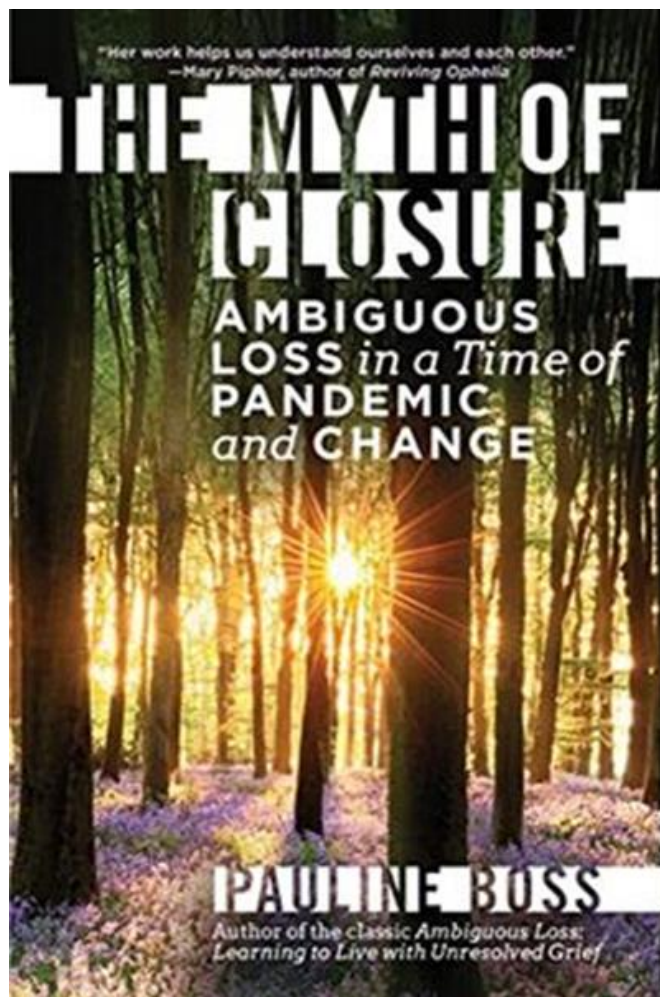
Come join us each Sunday – 10:10 am in room 310 (otherwise known as the choir room).

Holy Adventure

Holy Adventure is a daily devotional by Bruce Epperly with a fair amount of creation-based theology thrown in for good measure. It goes for 41 days, and each week is based on a theme, with some background reading about the theme. While Bruce Epperly wrote this devotional many years ago, and long before there was language around things like eco-justice or environmental theology, his reflections and devotions fit well for anyone looking for a daily focus that includes God's broad love and a love of all of creation. I highly recommend this book as a good addition to the sermon and class series this fall.

Inter-generational Choir

For Rally Day on 9/11 we are planning to combine the chancel choir with children, youth, and any other volunteers who would like to participate in singing a simple song to ring in the new church year! On Wednesday 9/7 we will have a brief rehearsal at 7:15 in the choir room to prepare. All are welcome!



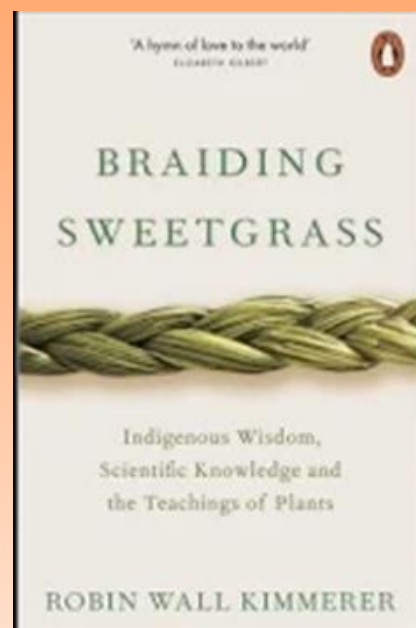
Myth of Closure

When we experience loss, we may participate in rituals that help us deal with that loss and the accompanying grief, but we don't actually get "closure" in the sense that the grief goes away and things return to as they were before. Minnesota-based therapist Pauline Boss first wrote about this in her book *Ambiguous Loss: Learning to Live with Unresolved Grief*. Since writing that book, we have encountered a world-wide pandemic as well as the world-wide reactions to the murder of George Floyd. Her follow-up book, *The Myth of Closure* addresses how these kinds of social ambiguous losses impact us, and how we can build resiliency in the face of ongoing loss. We'll be reading and discussing Boss' book on Monday evenings September 12 – October 17. That class will be entirely on zoom, so if you are interested in joining, please get the book and read it, and contact Becky for the zoom link.

Braiding Sweetgrass – Class and Sermons

Robin Wall Kimmerer has a PhD in Botany, and teaches Botany at State University of New York. She is also an enrolled member of the Citizen Potawatomi Nation. She does not see those identities as separate or at odds with one another, and her book, *Braiding Sweetgrass* is how she demonstrates that science and native knowledge and practices can work together. While divided into 5 sections (Planting, Tending, Picking, Braiding, Burning), the book is a series of essays woven through science, her family life, her students, and her engagement with a variety of native cultures.

This book is the basis of the sermon series September 25 – October 23, and there will also be a class to talk about the 5 sections on Tuesday mornings at 10:00, beginning on Sept. 20. The class will be a hybrid of in-person in Room 210 and zoom (to get the link, contact Becky or the office).



OLD FASHIONED Church Rummage Sale

**Lots of great stuff!
Housewares & Linens.
Toys. Books. Electronics.
And more!
(But no clothes)**



**Thursday, Friday & Saturday
Sept. 15, 16 & 17**

Day	Date	Time
Thursday	September 15	9:00 a.m. – 6:00 p.m.
Friday	September 16	9:00 a.m. – 6:00 p.m.
Saturday	September 17	9:00 a.m. – 12:00 noon

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 East 50th Street • MPLS • 612-721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org

Help! Yes. Help with the Rummage Sale!

Bring your rummage (not clothes or large furniture items; all working condition) to church on Sunday, September 4 or Sunday, September 11 as we have nowhere to store things before that.

Help setup and price on September 13 and 14. Help sell on September 15, 16, 17.

Please let Maureen Trepp or Kim Kanuit know you are able to help!



Grand Piano Update

Our new gently-used Kawai baby grand piano from Schmitt Music has arrived! It replaces our 27-year-old Baldwin baby grand, which was no longer able to be repaired. To help defray the \$11,900 cost of the piano, we need your help. So far we've raised \$4,750 in donations and \$1,000 in pledges, which gets us about halfway to our goal. We're asking for additional donations to fully cover the cost. Can you help? If so, please indicate on your check, envelope or in the Comment box for online giving that your contribution is for the piano. Thanks to everyone who has contributed already! We'll dedicate the new piano during an upcoming Sunday worship service this fall. Questions? Contact Jenny Ammerman

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer any-time between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! We'll be offering food on September 24, and October 22.

Toilet Paper Challenge!

In addition to food, our Minnehaha Food Shelf clients have an overwhelming need for personal care products like toothpaste and shampoo and diapers. Which is why the participating churches are being asked for donations of a different product every month. In August, it's toilet paper. Here's the challenge: Which church can donate the most rolls of toilet paper to the Food Shelf in the month of August! Bring your TP to the church and we'll keep track of the donations.

MONTH OF NOVEMBER



CANNED FOOD DRIVE

**CHILDREN & YOUTH ARE COLLECTING
NON PERISHABLE FOOD FOR THE
MINNEHAHA FOOD SHELF**

(Continued from page 1)

Aug. 28 Animal blessing

“Odd Stories of the Bible – Inappropriate Use of a Bear” *II Kings 2:23-25*

Sept. 4 Communion

“Odd Stories of the Bible – The Missing Axe” *II Kings 6:1-6*

Sept. 11 Fall Kick-Off Sunday

“Ever-Flowing Streams” *Amos 5:24*

Sept. 18 Confirmation Sunday

“Living Shrewdly” *Luke 16:1-8*

Sept. 25

Week 1: Planting “Use Your Gifts and Dreams for Good”

Oct. 2 World Communion Sunday

Week 2: Tending “Thanksgiving Address” *Psalms 8:3-9*

Oct. 9

Week 3: Picking “Honorable Harvest” *Leviticus 19:9-10*

Oct. 16

Part 4: Braiding “How Can We Keep From Singing?” *Psalms 149:1-5*

Oct. 23

Part 5: Burning “Help and Hope” *Jeremiah 31:15; Isaiah 43:19*

Oct. 30

TBA

Nov. 6 All Saints Sunday

Communion

“God of the Living” *Luke 20:27-38*

Nov. 13

“A New Thing” *Isaiah 65:17-25*

Nov. 20 Christ the King Sunday

“All Things” *Colossians 1:15-20*





Forest Therapy

In early June, I participated in Forest Therapy, also known as Forest Bathing. It seemed a little weird from the title, but the description promised that this would not be a nature walk, nor a step-counting hike. It would be an opportunity to immerse oneself in nature with time for quiet and reflective conversation. We were advised to bring water, a chair, and bug repellent. A group of about 20 gathered in a park in Farmington, and we learned about the values of being out in nature, the research that is new as well as wisdom that has been around for hundreds and thousands of years.

And then we were given instructions for our reflection. We were to walk around for 20 minutes, noticing things that moved, then gather at a designated location at the end of the time. Once there, we passed around a talking stick as each person shared briefly what they had seen. We did this a number of times, each time with different instructions. It ended with a tea ceremony (Forest Therapy started in Japan). It was relaxing, and I learned things that I already knew experientially. Like, spending time in nature reduces our heart rate, reduces our stress hormones, and increases our immune system. And, these impacts on our body can last over a period of months if we spend a number of days outside. I learned the tree oils are good for us, and that we can absorb them from skin contact, but also we breathe them in when we are in an area with a lot of trees.

Then, a week and a half later, I left to spend 6 weeks in the outdoors. Granted, we did spend a lot of

renewal leave in the car, but 6 weeks of camping, eating most of our meals outside, walking in woods and a few cities and a lot of campground loops, I was aware that I was “stocking up” for the return to my normal life. We not only spent a lot of time outside, we also read a daily devotional called *Holy Adventure* by Bruce Epperly that touted the wonders of creation and all that God has given to us, and I read *Braiding Sweetgrass* by Robin Wall Kimmerer in preparation for this fall’s sermon series. I found my body, mind, and spirit all immersed in the ways in which God shows up, gives, and beckons.

I plan to learn some more about Forest Therapy in the coming months, so you may be hearing more about that. And, see elsewhere in the newsletter for the sermon series on *Braiding Sweetgrass* as well as recommendations to utilize *Holy Adventure* for your own devotional time.

Renewal leave is time set apart, and not only does it come infrequently, not everyone can take that amount of time away from their regular schedule. Part of my commitment is to find pockets of time that renew my body and soul.

A day of Forest Therapy is good for the body and soul. An hour of reflective time and walking around the neighborhood is good for the body and soul. Whatever it is that renews you, engage in it. Don’t wait for an opportunity to take a long trip, find ways to do it every day so that we are always engaged in the work of being the people of God who respond to God’s call for us.

In Joy,
Becky





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9/22

Visit us online!
www.minnehaha.org

MINNEHAHA CHURCH

Wednesday Night Dinners

BEGIN ON
WEDNESDAY, SEPT. 14
5:30-6:15 PM

SUGGESTED COST:
\$5/PERSON OR \$20/FAMILY
(CHILDREN UNDER 5 EAT FREE)



VBS Compassion Camp—one of
many great events this summer!
See inside for more pictures!